



## FLY AGARIC

### *Amanita muscaria*

The fly agaric is arguably the most famous of all fungi, and it appears in illustrations in children's books all over the world. The bright scarlet cap, usually scattered with white spots of veil tissue, make it one of the easiest fungi to identify. Found originally throughout most of Europe, northern Asia, and North America, it now grows wherever humans have planted the host trees – usually birch – with which the fungus forms a mutually beneficial relationship. It is now commonly found in parts of Africa, India, and Australasia. All parts of the fly agaric are poisonous, although rarely fatal.



**SIZE** Cap diameter 6–15 cm (2¼–6 in)  
**HABITAT** Birch and pine woods  
**DISTRIBUTION** Almost worldwide  
**SPORE COLOUR** White

large floppy ring  
is easily torn